

Carpenters Fiji: Subsidiary Comparison

Research summary for the Car Rental & Equipment Web System project — comparing Carpenters Motors/Rentals, Carptrac and Carpenters Hardware as candidate subsidiaries.

Carpenters Fiji Pte Limited (a subsidiary of MBf Holdings) operates as a group of independent trading divisions rather than a single business with branches. Of these, Carpenters Motors/Rentals is the confirmed fit for the car rental side of the proposed system. For the ‘equipment’ side, two divisions are plausible candidates — Carptrac (heavy industrial machinery) and Carpenters Hardware (tools and building materials) — and the table below compares all three in detail to support that decision and the requirements-gathering work ahead.

Attribute	Carpenters Motors / Rentals	Carptrac	Carpenters Hardware
Trading Name(s)	Carpenters Motors (dealership & servicing); Carpenters Rentals (car hire brand)	Carptrac Fiji Pte Ltd	Carpenters Hardware
Parent / Group	Carpenters Fiji Pte Limited (subsidiary of MBf Holdings)	Carpenters Fiji Pte Limited; historically traded under WR Carpenter (SP) Limited and Subsidiaries (Fiji Group)	Carpenters Fiji Pte Limited (subsidiary of MBf Holdings)
Established / History	100+ years of automotive trading experience in Fiji	Established 1928 as authorised Caterpillar dealer — one of the oldest Cat dealerships outside the USA	Part of Carpenters' 150-year Fiji trading history; had at least 13 stores by 2014 and has continued to expand
Core Business	New & used vehicle sales, servicing, parts, panel & paint, and car rental	Sale, servicing and parts support of Caterpillar heavy/light machinery and generators	Retail & wholesale of building materials, hardware, power tools and electrical products
Role in Proposed System	Car rental component — confirmed fit	Candidate for ‘equipment’ — industrial / heavy plant hire	Candidate for ‘equipment’ — hand & power tools, builders’ equipment
Number of Branches	3 rental locations; 4 dealership locations (some overlap)	3 branches	13+ branches (as of 2014 count; likely more today)
Branch Locations	• Suva (Rentals & Dealership) – 61–63 Foster Rd, Walu Bay • Nadi Airport (Rentals) • Nadi (Dealership) – WHL Business Warehouse, Nadi Back Rd • Lautoka (Dealership) – Velovelo, Queens Rd • Labasa (Rentals & Dealership) – Rosawa St	• Suva – 1 Carpenters St, Raiwai • Lautoka – Velovelo Rd, Navutu • Labasa – Rosawa St	• Suva – 46 Matua St, Walu Bay • Suva – Vivrass Plaza, Laucala Beach Estate • Suva – Naulu, Kings Rd • Nausori – 6 Gulab Nabi Rd • Navua – Main St • Nadi – Narewa Junction, Namotomoto • Lautoka – Vuniwai Lane • Levuka – Main St • Savusavu – Main St • Taveuni – Somosomo • Labasa – Rosawa Rd

Attribute	Carpenters Motors / Rentals	Carptrac	Carpenters Hardware
Core Asset Categories	- Rental fleet: sedans, SUVs, minivans, 4WDs - New vehicle brands sold: Nissan, Hyundai, Isuzu, Honda, Range Rover, Jaguar, Infiniti, Renault - Special Purpose Vehicles division	- Cat® heavy machinery: excavators, dozers, loaders, scrapers, trucks - Olympian / CAT generators - Spare parts inventory	- Power tools (Makita agency) - Builders' equipment (Flextool) - Dressed timber (pine & native) - Steel products (beams, sheets, rods) - Electrical, lighting, plumbing, tiles, paints
Example Assets	Sedans, SUVs, 4WDs, minivans available for rent; new Hyundai, Isuzu, Honda, Range Rover, Jaguar models for sale	300+ Cat machine models incl. excavators, dozers, loaders; Olympian generators	Makita drills/saws, Flextool compaction & concrete equipment, dressed timber, steel beams/sheets/rods, tiles, paints
Asset Scale Indicator	100+ vehicle rental fleet	F\$3 million+ in spare parts inventory alone; 300+ machine product line	No public figure disclosed; multi-branch retail stock spread across 13+ locations
Business Model	Short-term (daily/weekly) car hire; vehicle sales; hire-purchase financing via Carpenters Finance	Primarily sale of new/used machinery plus parts & service; no confirmed public hire desk	Primarily retail/wholesale sale; no confirmed public hire desk
Target Customers	Tourists (Nadi Airport); local individuals & businesses; corporate hire	Construction & civil contractors; hospitality sector (generators); industrial operators	Tradespeople/carpenters; DIY & home improvement customers; small-to-large contractors; agricultural customers
Operating Hours	Rentals: 7 days incl. public holidays, 8:00am–5:00pm	Not publicly listed – confirm with client	Not publicly listed – confirm with client
Contact / Enquiries	+679 331 1000 (rentals) - sale.motors@carpenters.com.fj	+679 229 5285 - info@carptrac.com.fj	+679 331 3155 (Suva) - suva.hw@carpenters.com.fj
Confirmed Hire/Rental Service?	Yes – core business is car rental	Not confirmed publicly – appears sale/service focused	Not confirmed publicly – appears retail focused
System Design Considerations	- Booking calendar per vehicle & branch - Daily / weekly / monthly pricing tiers - Driver licence verification - Deposit & damage-policy tracking - Link to service/maintenance scheduling	- High-value asset tracking & maintenance logs - Possible delivery/logistics coordination - Operator certification requirements - Likely quote-based rather than fixed pricing - Longer hire terms (weekly/monthly)	- Large SKU count across many branches - Per-branch stock/inventory levels - Category taxonomy (tools/materials/electrical) - Possible short-term tool-hire model - Simpler, higher-volume, lower-value transactions

Open Questions for the Client

- Which subsidiary did Carpenters Fiji intend for the 'equipment' side of the system — Carptrac (heavy plant) or Carpenters Hardware (tools)? The two imply very different data models.
- Is equipment actually available for hire/rental today, or only for sale? Neither division publicly documents a formal hire desk — this may be a manual/informal process, or a new capability the client wants built.

- Which two specific branches (per confirmed subsidiary) should be the focus of initial data collection and requirements gathering?
- What internal data can the client share: current fleet/stock counts, any existing booking or inventory system, pricing structures, staff roles involved in check-out/check-in, and maintenance/condition tracking?
- What is typical demand seasonality (e.g., tourist season for rentals, construction project cycles for equipment) and how reliable is internet connectivity at each branch under consideration?

Sources

- carpenters.com.fj – Carpenters Fiji Pte Limited (About, Locations, Retail pages)
- carpmotors.com.fj – Carpenters Motors Fiji (Rentals, Contact & Locations pages)
- carphardware.com.fj – Carpenters Hardware
- carptrac.com.fj – Carptrac Fiji, Authorised Cat® Dealer (About Us, Hometest/Locations, New Equipment pages)
- fhfa.com.fj – Fiji Hotel & Tourism Association business listing for Carptrac Fiji Pte Ltd
- myjobsfiji.com – Carpenters Hardware division profile
- fastfind.com.fj – Carpenters Hardware branch directory
- yellowpagesfiji.com – Carpenters Rentals branch & fleet details